Q+A

MAN OF MANY PARTS

Actor and entrepreneur ***KUNAL KAPOOR*** *on his recent film* Jewel Thief *and everything else that's keeping him busy*

Q. Your recent project, *Jewel Thief: The Heist Begins*, marks your return to films after a four-year hiatus.
It wasn't deliberate; it's just that I wasn't getting the kind of roles I wanted to do. During this time, I attended workshops to learn new skills like clowning and pursued my passion for writing. In the past few years, I have put together a writer's room to create the content I am passionate about. The plan is to act in some and produce others.

Q. How was it being a part of an ensemble project that stars the likes of Saif Ali Khan and Jaideep Ahlawat?
Jewel Thief is a rollercoaster ride, with one twist after another. It's great popcorn entertainment. People believe such films are easier to make vis-à-vis serious projects, but they require a great amount of craft too. I played the role of a tough cop, a welcome departure from the peacemaker, philosopher or poet I usually am on screen. I didn't share much screen space with Jaideep, but it was great spending time with Saif.

Q. You are also an entrepreneur. What led you to establish a crowdfunding platform over a decade ago?
I have always been a nerd with a keen interest in technology. And then there's the part of me that wanted to help people. The idea was to leverage technology and create a transparent platform where those who sought help could reach out to individuals capable of providing financial assistance. That's how Ketto came to life.

Q. What's next on the cards?
I am co-producing a dramedy, which should hopefully go on the floors this year. It's too early to speak about it. I have also just finished a Telugu film, *Vishwambhara*, starring Chiranjeevi. I play the role of the antagonist, something I have never done before.

—with Geetika Sachdev